

Amazon SES Email Setup

Setup guide for send@mswoverwatch.com via Amazon SES

OPTION: AMAZON SES (NOT SMTP, NOT GRAPH)

Send as send@mswoverwatch.com through the Amazon SES HTTPS API. Lowest cost at volume; more AWS setup than Postmark.

Critical: Leave the SES sandbox (request production access) before sending to vendors. A small Overwatch code change is still required.

AT A GLANCE

Field	Value
Best for	Lowest cost at volume; leave Microsoft sending
From address	send@mswoverwatch.com
Protocol	HTTPS Amazon SES API — not SMTP, not Graph
AWS region	Stay in one region, e.g. US East (N. Virginia) us-east-1
App status	Account + DNS first; a small Overwatch code change is still required
Cost	Pay per email (fractions of a cent). No \$15 monthly floor.

Every new SES account starts in a sandbox: you can only mail verified addresses until AWS approves production. Vendor Daily Runs will fail until that request is approved. Keep Reply-To as `overwatch@metroshoewarehouse.com`.

PART A — AWS ACCOUNT AND DOMAIN

1. Open SES in the right region

1. Sign in at console.aws.amazon.com

- Region menu (top right) → US East (N. Virginia) us-east-1.
- Search Amazon SES and open it. SES settings are per region — do not switch later.

2. Create the domain identity

1. Identities → Create identity

- Identity type: Domain.
- Domain: mswoverwatch.com.
- Leave Easy DKIM on, 2048-bit.
- Create identity, then copy the three CNAME records SES shows.

3. Add DNS records

Add the three DKIM CNAMEs at the DNS host for mswoverwatch.com. Do not remove website A/CNAME records.

Type	Name / value
CNAME × 3	Exact DKIM names and values from the SES console
TXT (SPF)	v=spf1 include:amazonses.com ~all — edit an existing SPF; do not add a second SPF
TXT (DMARC, recommended)	_dmarc → v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:overwatch@metroshoewarehouse.com

Wait until the SES identity status is Verified. On Cloudflare, DKIM CNAMEs must be DNS only (grey cloud), not proxied. Custom MAIL FROM (e.g. bounce.mswoverwatch.com) is optional.

PART B — LEAVE THE SANDBOX

In the sandbox you can only send to verified addresses, max 200/day. This is required for vendor mail.

1. SES → Account dashboard → Request production access

- Mail type: Transactional.
- Website: <https://www.mswoverwatch.com>

Paste this use-case text:

We send transactional MAP pricing exception reports after scheduled jobs in MSW Overwatch (<https://www.mswoverwatch.com>). Recipients are business vendor contacts who opted in through our app. Volume is roughly one email per vendor per day, with an Excel attachment. We will use SES bounce/complaint notifications and will not send marketing or purchased lists.

AWS often replies within about a day. While waiting, verify your own email as an identity so you can test in the sandbox.

PART C — CREDENTIALS FOR OVERWATCH

Prefer the SES API (HTTPS), not SES SMTP.

1. IAM → Users → Create user (e.g. msw-overwatch-ses)

- Attach an inline policy with `ses:SendEmail` and `ses:SendRawEmail`.

2. Create an access key

- Use case: Application running outside AWS.
- Save `AWS_ACCESS_KEY_ID`, `AWS_SECRET_ACCESS_KEY`, and region `us-east-1`.

```
{
  "Version": "2012-10-17",
  "Statement": [{
    "Effect": "Allow",
    "Action": ["ses:SendEmail", "ses:SendRawEmail"],
    "Resource": "*"
  }]
}
```

PART D — BOUNCES (RECOMMENDED)**1. SNS → create topic ses-bounces.****2. SES → Identities → mswoverwatch.com → Notifications**

- Send bounce and complaint to that SNS topic. Subscribe your own email so you see failures.

PART E — POINT OVERWATCH AT SES

Overwatch today only knows SMTP and Graph. After SES is verified, add an SES transport in the API.

```
EMAIL_TRANSPORT=ses
EMAIL_FROM=send@mswoverwatch.com
EMAIL_FROM_NAME=MSW Overwatch
AWS_REGION=us-east-1
AWS_ACCESS_KEY_ID=<iam access key>
AWS_SECRET_ACCESS_KEY=<secret>
```

- From: MSW Overwatch <send@mswoverwatch.com>
- Reply-To: overwatch@metroshoewarehouse.com

PART F — TEST

When	What to do
Sandbox	Send only to a verified personal address. Confirm From is send@mswoverwatch.com.
After production access	POST /api/v1/reports/test-email to a real inbox you control, then one Daily Run.

Tell vendors: reports will come from send@mswoverwatch.com; replies go to overwatch@metroshoewarehouse.com.

WHAT THIS WILL NOT DO

- Mail will not appear in the Overwatch Outlook Sent folder.
- Open Overwatch draft still needs Graph if you keep that feature.
- Creating send@ as a Microsoft 365 mailbox puts you back on SMTP/Graph.

GOTCHAS

Issue	What it means
Sandbox	Tests work; vendor mail fails until production access is approved
Wrong region	Identities and credentials are per region — stay on us-east-1
Cloudflare orange cloud	DKIM CNAMEs must be DNS only or verification never completes
Second SPF record	Breaks authentication — edit the existing TXT instead

CHECKLIST

- AWS account, region us-east-1

- SES domain identity mswoverwatch.com + Easy DKIM
- Three DKIM CNAMEs + SPF (do not break the website)
- Identity Verified
- Request production access
- IAM user with ses:SendEmail + ses:SendRawEmail
- Bounce/complaint SNS
- Add SES transport in Overwatch + Render env
- Test, then production send